

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Security Consultant | Microsoft 365 Defender | Microsoft Sentinel | Entra ID | Intune | Purview

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Professional and Microsoft security specialist with over five years of hands-on experience designing, deploying, and optimising Microsoft security solutions including Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (AD)), Microsoft Intune, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Purview, and related identity, endpoint, and information protection services. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am adept at securing Microsoft cloud, hybrid, and on-premises environments at enterprise scale. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I deployed and managed the full Microsoft Defender suite (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365) for over 8,000 users, and I have built advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) detections, automation playbooks, and threat-hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel. I bring both technical depth and the ability to translate complex security requirements into clear, customer-facing recommendations, making me well-suited to a blended pre-sales and post-sales consulting role at a Microsoft Solutions Partner.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Platform:** Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365, Microsoft Sentinel
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (AD)), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Endpoint and Mobile Management:** Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM)), device compliance, application packaging and deployment
- **Data Protection and Compliance:** Microsoft Purview (Data Loss Prevention (DLP), sensitivity labelling, information protection, compliance management), Microsoft Priva
- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL-based detection rule development, threat-hunting queries, SOAR playbook automation
- **EDR and Threat Response:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), incident response, threat hunting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, KQL
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design, deploy, and optimise the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 users, including policy configuration, alert investigation, threat hunting, and response.
- Operate and engineer Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, building KQL detection rules, automation playbooks, and threat-hunting queries to support 24/7 Security Operations.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM), enforcing Zero Trust identity controls across the enterprise.

- Manage Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM) for enterprise-wide endpoint compliance, device enrolment, application management, and Conditional Access integration.
- Operate Microsoft Purview for Data Loss Prevention (DLP), sensitivity labelling, and information protection across Microsoft 365 services.
- Present technical security findings and recommendations to stakeholders, translating complex security telemetry and risk data into clear, actionable advice.
- Lead incident response engagements, leveraging Microsoft Defender XDR and Microsoft Sentinel to investigate, contain, and recover from security incidents.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR as complementary security platforms alongside the Microsoft stack.
- Execute vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Pentra BAS, AppCheck, and Nessus; manage remediation programmes and report risk reduction to leadership.
- Deliver security awareness training and contribute to security policy development aligned with ISO 27001, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials+.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Administered Microsoft Entra ID/Azure AD, Group Policy, and user access controls, supporting IAM for 8,000 users.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI): platform configuration, alert triage, and incident response.
- Developed KQL detection queries and threat-hunting content in Microsoft Sentinel to improve detection coverage and reduce false-positive rates.
- Managed Microsoft Intune compliance policies and supported device enrolment across the Microsoft 365 estate.
- Administered Mimecast email security gateway alongside Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 to provide layered email protection.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus; supported structured remediation and reporting.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns, supporting the organisation's security culture programme.
- Supported PAM operations and joiners/movers/leavers access review processes.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Administered Microsoft 365 services, endpoint security, and Mobile Device Management (MDM) tooling in a SaaS and FinTech environment.
- Managed Active Directory, Group Policy, and user provisioning; supported firewall and VPN administration.
- Supported vulnerability assessment, patch management, and ISO 27001 compliance activities.
- Delivered IT security support and security awareness training to staff.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and managed the Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 UAL users, achieving enterprise-wide threat detection coverage and significantly reducing MTTD and MTTR.
- Implemented Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA rollout for 8,000 users, enforcing Zero Trust and materially reducing identity-related security incidents.
- Built a robust Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment with custom KQL detection rules and SOAR playbooks, reducing manual analyst workload and improving detection fidelity.
- Deployed BeyondTrust PAM, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and delivering a comprehensive privileged session audit capability.
- Implemented Microsoft Purview Data Loss Prevention (DLP) controls, reducing data exfiltration risk across Microsoft 365 services.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ certification attainment for UAL, demonstrating compliance with UK government security baseline controls.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000-90,000 | Remote (UK/Ireland)